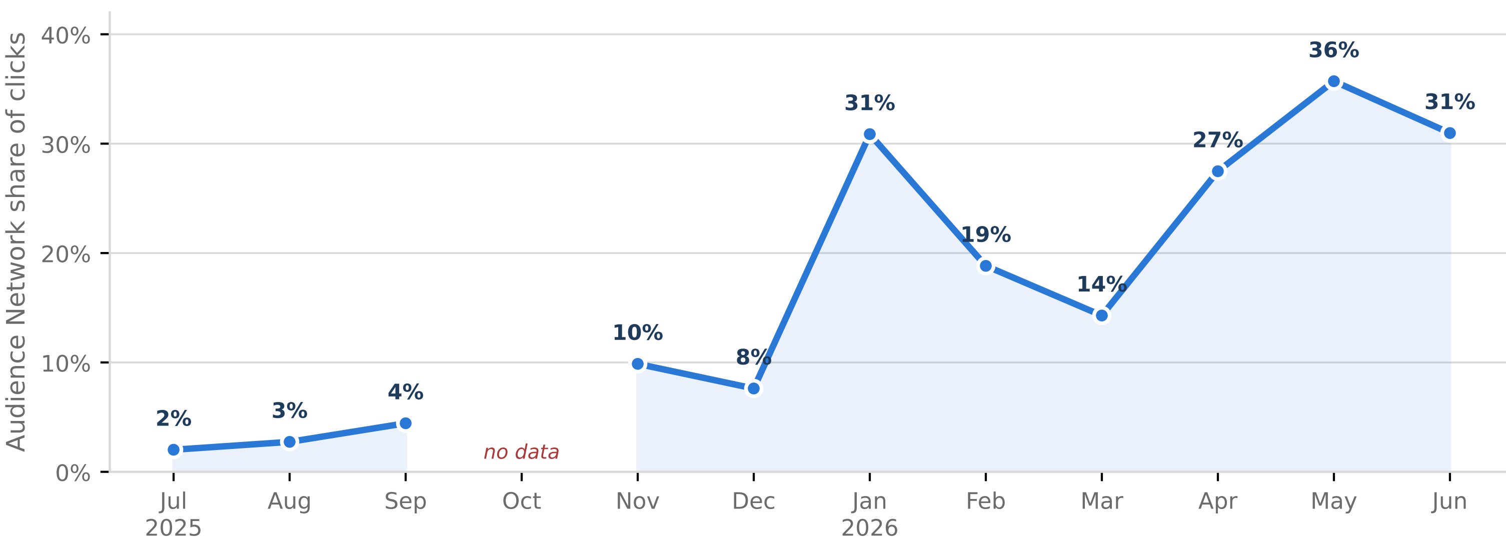
Meta Ads: Audience Network share of clicks

Souled | Trailing 12 months (Jul 2025 to Jun 2026)

Latest (Jun 2026)	12-month peak (May)	Where it started (Jul 2025)
30.97%	**35.71%**	**2.02%**
of all clicks on Audience Network	highest share in the period	a roughly 15x increase since



What this shows

- **Audience Network has gone from a rounding error to a third of clicks.**
  Its share sat near 2 to 4% through summer 2025 and stepped up sharply at the start of 2026, holding around 28 to 36% since.

- **This warrants a quality check, not just a volume read.**
  Audience Network clicks are typically cheaper but lower intent (in-app taps across third-party properties). A rising share can inflate click counts while pulling down lead quality. Page 2 shows the impact on conversion rate and cost per lead.

- **Note on October 2025.**
  There was no paid delivery that month, so it appears as a gap rather than a zero.

Source: Windsor.ai Facebook connector. Metric: clicks by placement. Audience Network clicks divided by total clicks across all placements. Prepared 2026-06-29.

The impact on conversion rate and cost per lead

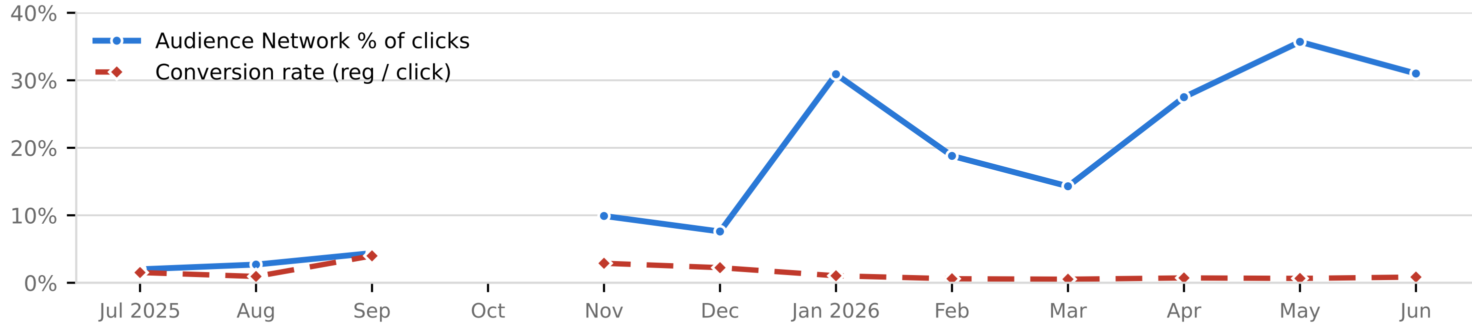
As Audience Network's share rose, fewer clicks converted and each lead cost more

Audience Network share
4% → 27%
H2 2025 vs H1 2026

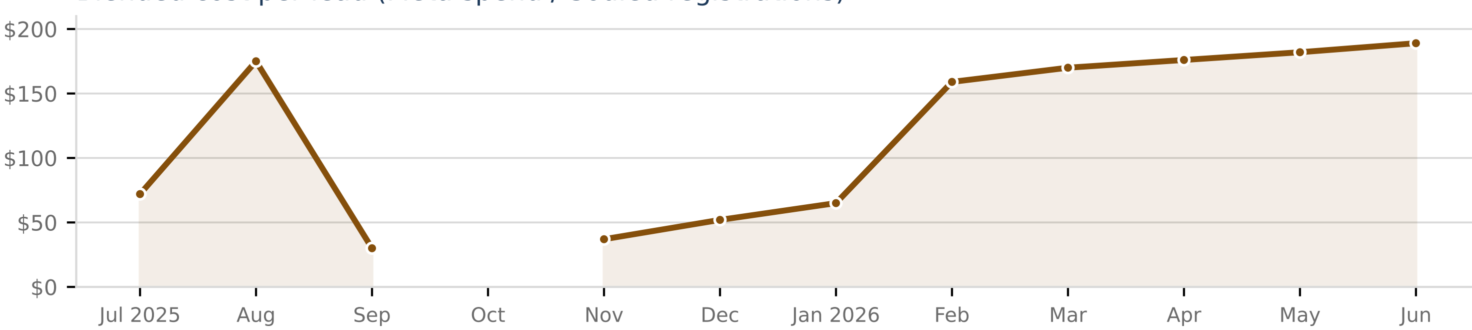
Conversion rate (reg / click)
1.79% → 0.76%
cut by more than half

Blended cost per lead
$70 → $135
nearly doubled

Audience Network share vs conversion rate



Blended cost per lead (Meta spend / Souled registrations)



How to read this

- **The low-quality traffic and the weak results moved together.**
  Through the high Audience Network period, the click-to-registration rate more than halved and cost per lead nearly doubled. Clicks piled up without becoming registrations.
- **This is a blended correlation, not a measured Audience Network cost per lead.**
  Meta does not report conversions by placement for this account, so Audience Network's own cost per lead cannot be isolated. Conversion rate and cost per lead here are blended across all placements.
- **Audience Network is the clearest marker of a broader shift, likely not the sole cause.**
  The change began in January 2026, alongside the shared-pixel targeting drift. Limiting Audience Network is a reasonable lever to test, but on its own it will not undo that drift.

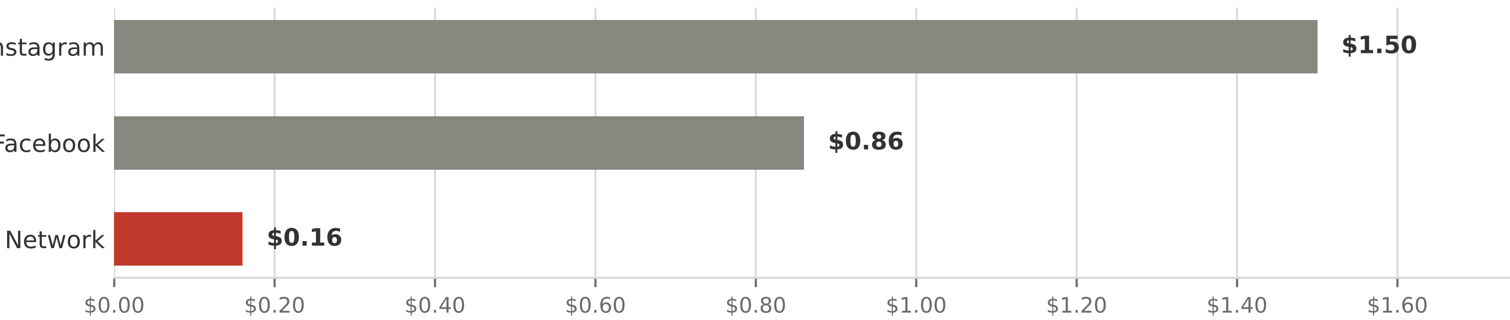
Clicks and spend: Windsor.ai Facebook connector. Leads: Salesforce Registration (Souled program, test records excluded). 'H2 2025' = Jul to Dec 2025, 'H1 2026' = Jan to Jun 2026. October 2025 had no paid delivery. Prepared 2026-06-29.

Why this points to Audience Network

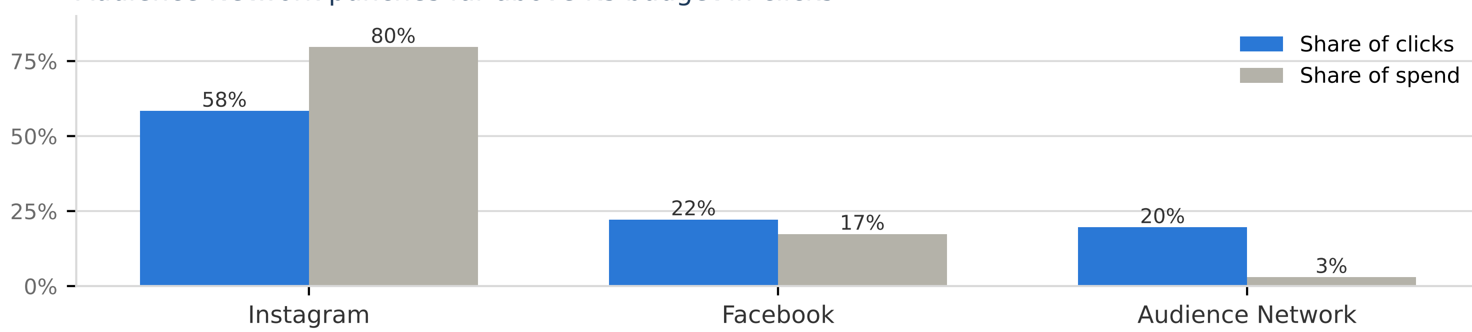
Audience Network buys a fifth of your clicks for 3% of spend, because the clicks are nearly free

Audience Network CPC	Click share vs spend share	Click-through rate
$0.16	**20% / 3%**	**~11% / ~1%**
vs $1.50 Instagram, $0.86 Facebook	one fifth of clicks, 3% of budget	Audience Network vs Instagram

Cost per click by placement (trailing 12 months)



Audience Network punches far above its budget in clicks



What to do with this

- **The cheap clicks come from an abnormal click rate, not cheap impressions.**
  Audience Network's cost per thousand impressions is actually the highest of any placement, yet its cost per click is the lowest. That only happens when an unusually high share of viewers tap the ad (around 11%, versus about 1% on Instagram), the classic pattern of accidental in-app taps rather than genuine interest.
- **Excluding Audience Network is a low-cost, low-risk test.**
  It is under 3% of spend, so dropping it sacrifices almost no real reach or budget. The benefit is cleaner signal: it stops feeding the pixel cheap non-converting clicks that pull the blended conversion rate down and can mistrain the optimizer.
- **Set expectations honestly.**
  Because Audience Network is so little spend, excluding it will not by itself slash cost per lead. The value is a cleaner click-to-registration signal and better pixel training, which support the broader fix to the shared-pixel targeting drift.

Source: Windsor.ai Facebook connector, by placement, trailing 12 months (Jul 2025 to Jun 2026). CPC = spend / clicks; CPM = spend / impressions x 1000; CTR =